

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~
HEADQUARTERS
SUB-REGION DARMSTADT
COUNTER INTELLIGENCE CORPS REGION III

000709

XX 1/75
8 March 1948

III-D-1648.1

MEMORANDUM FOR THE OFFICER IN CHARGE

SUBJECT: HORTEN, Reimer and Walter (Brothers).

Re: Operation HARASS

Regraded ~~CONFIDENTIAL~~ by authority of

Col 9 May 48 by Bly

L. E. Phillips 2d Lt ORDC

1. Reason for Investigation on 1-31-57

Reference is made to letter, Headquarters Counter Intelligence Corps Region I, 970th CIC Detachment, European Command, APO 154, dated 26 January 1948, file No. 1-1606; subject: HORTEN, Reimer and Walter (Brothers); Re: HARASS.

2. Results of Investigative Activity:

a. In the above mentioned reference Professor Fnu. SKEKAL is reported living either in the DARMSTADT (L50/M54), FRANKFURT (L51/M67), or WALBURG (LE2/H49) area, and is reported as a possible lead concerning the HORTEN brothers; (see subject).

b. Adolf SKEKAL, Professor, Doctor, Philosophie, is presently residing at [REDACTED] is administrative and liaison leader of the scientists in the DARMSTADT area. When contacted, SKEKAL stated that the last he had heard concerning the HORTEN brothers was that they were residing at STUTTGART (L49/302), BADEN-BADEN. As to their present residence, SKEKAL could furnish no further information. They lived and carried out their experiments with motorless, and tail-less planes during the war at SCHWABNISCH GMEIND (L49/S52), BADEN-BADEN. The HORTEN brothers worked very closely with the SKEIBEL and JUNKERS Factories, which were engaged in the designing and construction of various aircraft. SKEKAL offered the following named persons, who were connected with the two (2) above mentioned firms, as lead, concerning the HORTEN brothers:

(1) Franz WALTER, Betriebsfuhrer, [REDACTED]

(2) Paul KNEPPER, Engineer, [REDACTED]

(3) Friedrich FECHER, Engineer, [REDACTED]

(4) Fnu HENSKEL, Engineer, [REDACTED]

(5) Ernst SKEIBERT, Engineer, [REDACTED]

Evaluation: P-3.

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c. Interview of Ernst SCHUBERT, who is located in this area, revealed the following information relative to SUBJECT: SCHUBERT, who was formerly chief testpilot for Junkers Aircraft corporation, was not acquainted with the HORTEN brothers, but knows that they built the first "tail-less" plane ever flown in GERMANY. Experiments with this craft were made at SCHWAEBISCHHOFEN, however, the date is not known. Toward the end of the war the BRITISH evacuated the HORTEN brothers to TOTTINGEN (L52/CB2), BRITISH Zone, and allowed them to resume work of their "tail-less" aircraft. During 1946 they were transported to ENGLAND to make test flights for official purposes. The results have never been revealed; however, the HORTEN brothers who had been promised entrance to ENGLAND were returned to TOTTINGEN and told that at the present time, due to lack of funds, the ENGLISH could not bring scientists and important technicians into ENGLAND. Upon their release from the ENGLISH, the HORTEN brothers were not allowed to continue their work. SCHUBERT furnished the following named person as a possible lead concerning the HORTEN brothers:

(1) Hanna REITSCH, presently residing at [REDACTED], famous woman pilot of GERMANY, was well acquainted with the HORTEN brothers. SCHUBERT stated that REITSCH did test flying of the HORTEN aircraft.

d. Interview of Walter REICH, Electrical Engineer, residing at [REDACTED] revealed the following information: The HORTEN brothers were, the foremost glider experts of GERMANY for many years. During the war they were in the neighborhood of WURZBURG (L50/K33), WORTENBURG BADEN. Throughout the entire war they carried on top secret wind tunnel tests. The wind tunnels, believed to be the largest and most modern of that time were located at SCHWAEBISCHHOFEN. The work of the HORTEN was closely related with the SKIBEL factory at the end of the war (1945). During 1946 REICH heard that the HORTEN brothers were located at or near STUTTGART, where also the remains of the firm SKIBEL had been evacuated. Sometime in 1947 REICH learned that Fm. SKIBEL had left his firm (disposition of firm unknown) and had taken up residence at [REDACTED].

In connection with this he learned also that the HORTEN brothers, along with other SKIBEL personnel had moved to FRANCE under contract with the FRENCH Government. Upon request of the undersigned, REICH learned the following: The HORTEN brothers are in FRANCE living at DECIZE, approximately one-hundred and ninety (190) miles southeast of PARIS. DECIZE is located on the Loire River. The HORTEN brothers are working on very important experiments, together with a Professor Fm. FRANZ, an Aerodynamics expert who was considered topnotch with the Junkers Motor Building factory located at DESLIEUX (M52/K17). There is a Colony of approximately two-hundred (200) aircraft designers, builders, technicians and their families located at DECIZE. (P-2)

e. Additional information concerning (1) SKIBEL, (2) SCHUBERT, and (3) REICH is listed:

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GRADED UNCLASSIFIED (1)

6 JUL 1994

CDR USAINSCOM F01/PO

HL Rm 1-003 DOD 5200.10

Name..... Adolf SKIBEL

Birthdate.....

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5USC552 (b) (6) & (b) (7) (C)

Birthplace.....
Occupation...Theoretical Physics Expert
Address..... (former)

(2) Name.....Ernst SKIBERT
Birthdate.....
Birthplace.....
Occupation...Airplane Testpilot, designer.
Address.....

(3) Name.....Walter REICH
Birthdate.....
Birthplace.....
Occupation...Radar, Electronic expert.
Address.....

is presently awaiting orders for immigration to the US.

3. Agent's Comments, Conclusions, and Recommendations:

a. The leads given in paragraph 2, sub-paragraph b (1), (2), (3), and (4); sub-paragraph c(1) be exploited.

b. That this case remain open and that an exchange of new developments be maintained by this office, CIO STUTTGART, and CIO FRANKFURT.

c. It is recommended that CIO STUTTGART, and CIO FRANKFURT be serviced with copies of this MOIC.

PIERS. AND IMPERS. INDEX

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"tail-less" plane
FRENCH Government

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